town, each township and village, and last but not least, our principal airport in the plain below.

We used to live penned in eight miles from the seashore and now, Mr. President, you suggest to us in your proposals that we return to almost that same situation.

Mr. President, you declare that you will not support the creation of a Palestinian state in Judea, Samaria, and the Gaza district. The Palestinian state will rise of itself the day Judea and Samaria are given to Jordanian jurisdiction; then in no time, you will have a Soviet base in the heart of the Middle East. Under no circumstances shall we accept such a possibility ever arising which would endanger our very existence. We have chosen for the last two years to call our countries friends and allies; such being the case, a friend does not weaken his friend, an ally does not put an ally in jeopardy; this would be the inevitable consequence for the positions transmitted to me on Aug. 31 to become a reality.

I believe they won't.

For Zion's sake, I will not hold my peace, and for Jerusalem's sake, I will not rest. (Isaiah, chapter 62)

Menachem

In my response to Begin the following day, I said that despite his cabinet's quick rejection of the proposal, even before it had been made public, I remained confident that it "contained the essential elements for achieving a durable peace in the Middle East which takes full account of Israel's security requirements. After further study, I hope you will share that belief with me . . . I want to reiterate once more our commitment and my commitment to the security of Israel and the Israeli people. Security can only be found in the context of a genuine peace constructed upon sound and enduring treaties between Israel and its Arab neighbors."